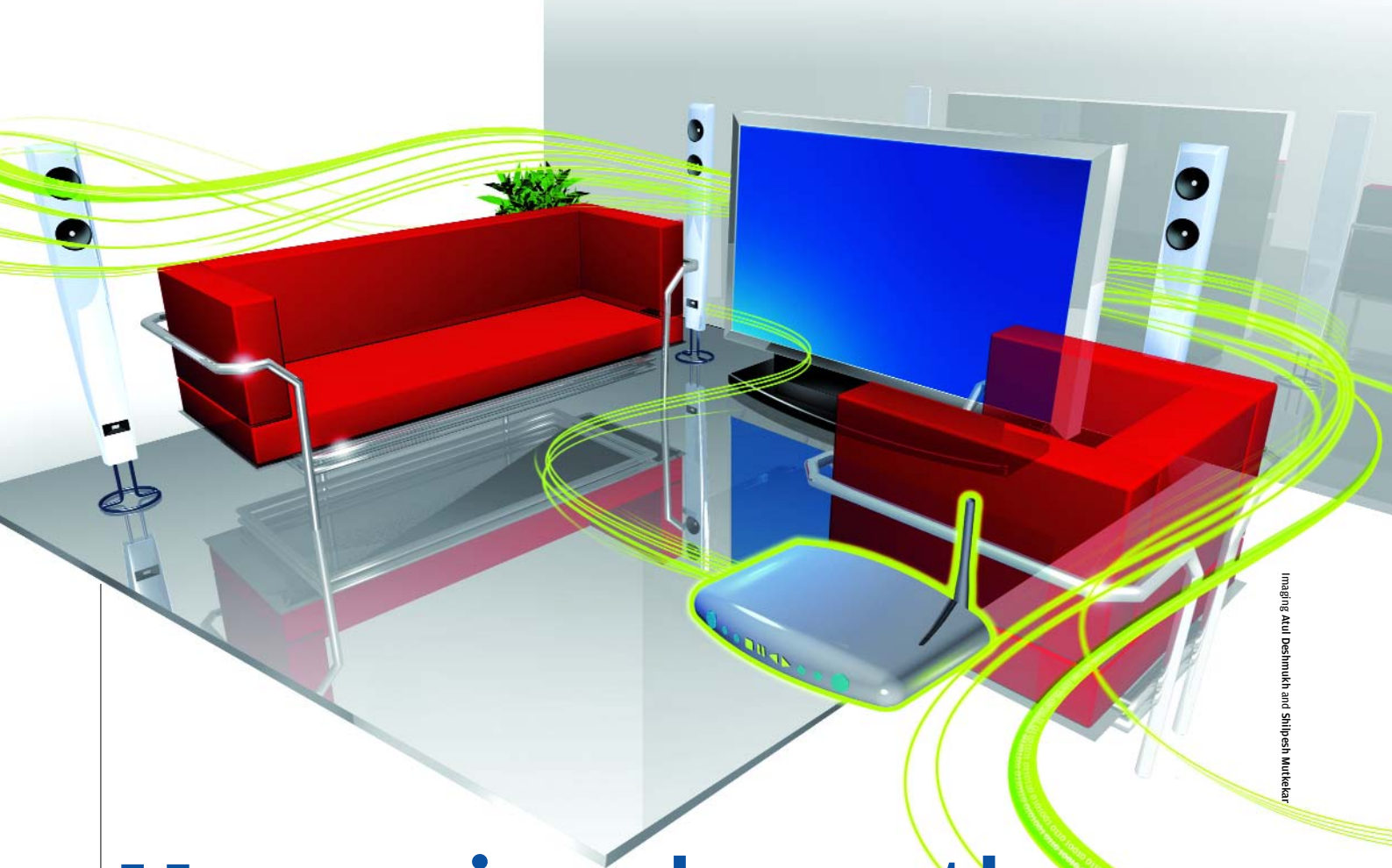




Imaging: Atul Deshmukh and Shipesh Mutkekar

Home is where the Entertainment is

You might just end up saying this as digital home entertainment brings the boom and the thunder of the movies into your drawing room

Deepak Dhingra

The “movie-outing,” as it is called, has traditionally been the primary mode of entertainment. The large screen, the surround sound experience entertains brilliantly—practically making you a part of the picture. But now with the convergence of different technologies, you can get quite close to the same ambience in the comfort of your living room.

With the universal remote in your hand, a bowl of popcorn in your lap, and your favourite armchair as your companion, you can control the way you are entertained. Significant developments pertaining to surrounding digital homes and convergence in the last year have made them a reality after the years of hype around them. Here’s a list of factors that have made digital home entertainment come true:

- ☑ High-performance processors and graphics
- ☑ Low cost storage

- ☑ Acceptance of WiFi
- ☑ Media Center PCs
- ☑ Falling prices of LCDs and flat-panel displays
- ☑ Wide acceptance of digital cameras and camcorders
- ☑ Acceptance of smart devices including cell phones and PDAs
- ☑ Ease of sharing data: Bluetooth, memory cards, PictBridge

Enough of theory. Let’s zoom right into devices that convert your home into a no-nonsense entertainment zone.

Media Center PCs

A PC can masquerade as an entertainment device to play music, games, etc. However, if you are looking at home entertainment, then you need a large television set, a HiFi stereo system and a movie player. A single contraption called the Media Center PC takes care of all this! Aptly described as putting the PC in the living room, Microsoft describes it as a digital media hub that combines all entertainment choices and